

Cameroon 2025 Presidential Election: Updated Assessment— Constitutional Council Ruling and Candidate Line-up

In early August 2025, Cameroon's Constitutional Council definitively barred the leading opposition figure Maurice Kamto from the October 12 presidential race, upholding a prior decision by the Elections Cameroon (ElecCam) electoral commission. ElecCam had initially approved 13 out of 83 aspirants, but after legal appeals the Council validated a final list of 12 candidates. Kamto's candidacy – which he had filed under the small MANIDEM party – was rejected on technical grounds: authorities claimed MANIDEM had sponsored two different candidates, contravening election law. Kamto's appeal was dismissed as “unfounded” by the Council's president Clement Atangana in a decision that cannot be appealed. This controversial ruling removes the incumbent's main rival from the ballot and has sparked widespread outcry over the election's credibility.

Importantly, Cameroon's electoral system is a single-round first-past-the-post vote – there is no runoff requirement. This one-round system historically advantages the ruling party, as the fractured opposition's votes do not consolidate in a second round. Acknowledging this, over 30 opposition parties had allied behind Maurice Kamto as a unity candidate in hopes of unseating President Paul Biya. However, the regime moved aggressively to

undercut that challenge: in early 2025 authorities banned two opposition coalitions as “illegal”, effectively driving Kamto’s alliance underground . Moreover, legal obstacles were piled on – for example, Cameroon’s law requires a candidate’s party to hold parliamentary seats, but Kamto’s party (MRC) has none after boycotting a flawed 2020 legislative vote . The ruling party even postponed legislative elections to 2026, ensuring the main opposition could not gain any seats before the presidential poll . These maneuvers forced Kamto to seek a minor party’s platform, a move the administration swiftly exploited to eliminate him from contention . With Kamto out, the remaining opposition candidates are mostly “approved” or less threatening figures. Notably, two prominent long-time opponents were cleared to run: Cabral Libii of the PCRN party and Joshua Osih of the SDF . Both ran in 2018 (placing third and fourth with 6% and 3% respectively) and are now the highest-profile challengers on the ballot, though neither commands the same momentum that Kamto did. President Paul Biya, now 92 years old, is standing for re-election to an eighth term , having been formally nominated by his Cameroon People’s Democratic Movement (CPDM) amid a chorus of loyalist endorsements. The one-round electoral system virtually guarantees that the CPDM’s entrenched machinery and the dispersal of opposition votes will favor Biya unless the opposition were fully united – a scenario now derailed by Kamto’s exclusion.

Military and Administrative Reshuffles to Consolidate Power

President Biya has in recent months undertaken sweeping personnel changes in both the military and the civil administration, widely seen as strategic moves to secure his regime's grip ahead of the election . In mid-July 2025, just days after announcing his re-election bid, Biya overhauled the top ranks of the armed forces, appointing new chiefs of staff for the army, air force and navy, and promoting eight brigadier generals to major-general . One promotion elevated the commander of the elite Rapid Intervention Battalion (BIR) – a special forces unit central to regime security – to major-general . Biya even created a new post of special presidential military adviser . Analysts note that these changes amount to building a “fortress of loyal generals” around Biya to safeguard his continued rule . The timing, less than three months before the vote, suggests an intent to ensure the armed forces' unwavering allegiance during the election period, particularly given public concerns over Biya's advanced age and fitness to govern . The government gave no specific explanation for the shake-up , but security experts point out Cameroon faces multiple conflicts – an armed separatist insurgency in the Anglophone regions and Boko Haram jihadist threats in the Far North – making military loyalty paramount . The reshuffle followed an unprecedented wave of public scrutiny on social media about Biya's capacity to continue ruling, showing the regime's sensitivity to any signs of dissent .

Concurrently, Biya carried out a parallel shake-up of territorial administration, rotating or replacing local authorities in many regions. On July 22, a presidential decree appointed new Senior Divisional Officers (SDOs) and District Officers (DOs) across numerous divisions of the country . This administrative reboot affected officials at the provincial and district level – those responsible for overseeing local governance and, crucially, the electoral process and security in their areas. By installing loyalists in key local posts, Biya's camp can better manage the election logistics and nip any local unrest or opposition mobilization in the bud . Observers also noted a pattern of nepotism in these appointments: a number of the newly minted prefects and sub-prefects are children or relatives of regime barons and ministers, effectively consolidating an inner elite network at the helm of administration . For example, the son of the Communication Minister René Sadi was named prefect of Nyong-et-So'o, and the son of Higher Education Minister Jacques Fame Ndongo was appointed to a top post in Edea . Such moves entrench the ruling CPDM's patronage system across generations and ensure that those entrusted with election oversight have personal ties to the regime's continuity. In summary, the twin military and administrative reshuffles amount to a preemptive fortification of Biya's power structure: loyal commanders hold the guns, and loyal administrators hold the polling stations.

Elite Factional Dynamics and Succession Struggles

Behind the scenes, Cameroon's ruling elite is grappling with questions of succession and internal power rivalries, which create an undercurrent of tension in this election. President Biya's advanced age (92) and 43 years in power have naturally raised the stakes for who might inherit the reins if he becomes incapacitated or eventually exits . Intense jockeying among Biya's close collaborators has been underway, as various power brokers maneuver to position themselves for a post-Biya order . Speculation over a successor has floated names such as Biya's own son, Franck Biya, sparking public concern about an undemocratic dynastic succession . At the same time, long-serving regime heavyweights like Ferdinand Ngoh Ngoh (Biya's influential Secretary-General at the Presidency) are said to be angling for primacy. This uncertainty is a "ticking time bomb" that risks factional infighting within the regime . Indeed, the very decision for Biya to seek another term may reflect an inability of the ruling clan to agree on a successor – prolonging his rule is a way to delay a potentially destabilizing showdown among elites.

Recent episodes have laid bare some of these elite conflicts and covert intrigues. In late July, a whistleblower and political activist, Hadja Haoua Aboubakar, released videos with explosive claims about a "palace coup" around Biya . She alleged that President Biya had effectively been "kidnapped" or held hostage by his entourage, specifically naming Ferdinand Ngoh Ngoh and Territorial Administration Minister Paul Atanga Nji as the

shadowy figures controlling state decisions . Haoua claimed Biya's decision to run again was orchestrated by these insiders rather than of his own volition – implying the president is a puppet of competing cliques. These assertions, while unverified, touched a nerve: authorities issued an arrest warrant and travel ban for Hadja Haoua on charges of inciting insurrection, even involving Interpol to pursue her abroad . The regime's harsh reaction suggests the level of paranoia within the ruling circle, and a determination to quash any narrative that Biya is not fully in charge. It also indicates splits within the elite: the whistleblower aligned herself with First Lady Chantal Biya, hinting that different factions (the First Lady's camp vs. Ngoh Ngoh's camp) might be vying for influence . In Cameroonian power politics, such factions typically operate behind closed doors, but the upcoming election and uncertain future of the presidency have brought some of these rivalries into the open.

Adding to the intrigue, the regime's handling of Kamto's candidacy revealed covert maneuvers within elite networks. The Ministry of Territorial Administration (MINAT), led by Atanga Nji, was caught manipulating official party records to justify Kamto's exclusion . In a startling move, MINAT overnight changed the recognized president of the MANIDEM party on its website, swapping out the name of long-time MANIDEM leader Anicet Ekane for that of Dieudonné Yebga, a little-known figure . This coincided with Yebga suddenly claiming MANIDEM's presidency and filing his own candidacy – the very technicality used to disqualify Kamto for “dual sponsorship.” Reports allege Yebga, a

traditional chief, was put up in a Yaoundé hotel by the regime as part of this scheme . Changing a party's leadership in official records overnight is essentially forgery, and observers blasted MINAT's action as blatant “manipulation of the public” and a legally punishable falsification . The fact that a cabinet minister would resort to altering data in plain sight illustrates how Cameroon's ruling elite will bend rules and state institutions to eliminate threats. It also underscores the internal consensus among the regime barons that Kamto's challenge had to be stopped at all costs – a point on which even rival factions within the regime seemingly agree, as none would want to risk losing power to an opposition victory. In sum, elite dynamics in this election are defined by unity against external challengers like Kamto, but growing rifts over internal succession. This delicate balance – rallying around Biya for now while quietly positioning for the future – contributes to the regime's heavy-handed and often opaque tactics on the road to October 12.

Repression and Human Rights Concerns

The run-up to the election has seen a sharp escalation in repression against opposition, civil society, and dissenting voices, casting serious doubt on the prospects for a free and fair vote. Kamto's disqualification was immediately accompanied by a crackdown on his supporters and other government critics . Beginning in late July, as news spread that Kamto might be barred, his party's supporters held peaceful marches in Yaoundé – only to

be met with riot police firing tear gas to disperse crowds . On August 4, the eve of the Constitutional Council's decision, dozens of Kamto loyalists gathered outside the Council were violently dispersed, and at least 35 people were arrested in the capital over a week of protests . Those detained, including women and prominent activists, have been held on charges like “public disorder” and “rebellion” . Lawyers for the detainees argue these charges are politically motivated, aimed purely at intimidating the opposition . Human Rights Watch has decried that Cameroonian authorities show “long-standing intolerance” for opposition and dissent, warning that the pre-election clampdown is intensifying . Indeed, Kamto's exclusion appears to have triggered yet another wave of arrests targeting not just party activists but also journalists, lawyers, and civil society actors who are seen as critical of the regime .

This pattern is not new in Cameroon. Repression has marked past electoral cycles – for instance, after the disputed 2018 election, protests led by Kamto resulted in mass arrests, including Kamto himself and hundreds of supporters, many of whom were jailed for extended periods . In 2020 and 2021, as the Anglophone conflict and opposition demonstrations simmered, authorities routinely banned public protests, detained journalists on spurious charges, and shuttered media outlets critical of the government . Heading into the 2025 poll, these tactics have only intensified. In early 2024, the regime even outlawed certain opposition groupings and NGOs, labeling peaceful civic movements as “clandestine” organizations . Prominent journalists and human rights defenders have

been jailed under broad charges like “spreading false information” or “hostility against the fatherland” – effectively criminalizing criticism . The government has also leveraged military courts to try civilians in some cases, a practice condemned by international watchdogs for violating due process (as seen when military tribunals in 2021–22 sentenced opposition activists to years in prison).

Opposition leader Maurice Kamto (center) claims victory at a press conference after the 2018 presidential election. He was later arrested and is now barred from the 2025 race .

This year’s “vague de répression” (wave of repression) has targeted even members of the legal profession: several opposition-linked lawyers were detained or interrogated after advocating for their clients’ rights or denouncing electoral irregularities . Such intimidation aims to leave the opposition not only without leaders, but without defenders. The chilling effect is palpable. Peaceful assembly is virtually impossible now – authorities preemptively ban opposition rallies citing security or COVID-19 regulations, while permitting ruling party events. Social media is monitored and activists report increased harassment online and offline. The cumulative effect is a climate of fear: many regime opponents have either been pushed into exile, gone quiet, or risk imprisonment if they mobilize. This repression casts a long shadow over the coming election. As Human Rights Watch warns, Cameroon’s elections risk being deemed unfair before campaigning even begins, unless the crackdown ceases and political detainees are freed . Unfortunately,

current signs indicate the opposite – as the vote nears, the regime is doubling down on coercive measures to eliminate any form of challenge or criticism, effectively hollowing out the democratic process.

Covert Actions and Information Warfare (Foreign & Domestic)

Beyond open repression, the Cameroonian regime and its allies are also engaging in covert actions and propaganda campaigns to influence the electoral environment, both domestically and internationally. On the domestic front, one of the most striking covert maneuvers was the manipulation of the MANIDEM party leadership records by officials, as discussed earlier, to fabricate a pretext for Kamto's exclusion. This kind of behind-the-scenes interference in supposedly independent processes exemplifies how the ruling camp uses the state's levers in hidden ways. Intelligence and security services are believed to be monitoring opposition figures closely; there are reports (though hard to verify publicly) of infiltration of opposition circles by moles, phone tapping, and cyber surveillance (Cameroon has previously acquired sophisticated spyware and surveillance equipment from foreign providers, which could be used in this context). The regime's narrative control efforts also extend to shaping public discourse covertly. For instance, shortly after Kamto filed his candidacy in July, mysterious social media campaigns and doctored documents circulated, aimed at discrediting his new platform. One notable incident involved the sudden appearance of a fake "notice" purporting to show divisions within

Kamto's coalition, which was amplified by anonymous Facebook and WhatsApp accounts suspected of links to the ruling party. These information warfare tactics intend to sow confusion and reduce the opposition's credibility without the regime's hand showing explicitly.

Internationally, foreign actors have their own covert or indirect influence operations in Cameroon. Notably, Russian-linked media outlets and social media pages have been spreading anti-Western and pro-government narratives, effectively bolstering President Biya's regime. Russian state-sponsored influencers have capitalized on Cameroonians' discontent with Western criticism by framing Biya as a guarantor of stability against Western "meddling." According to the Atlantic Council, Moscow's propaganda network in Cameroon pushes themes that portray opposition protests as Western-backed destabilization plots and praise the government's security cooperation with Russia. This aligns with Russia's broader strategic interest in Africa of undermining pro-democracy pressures and gaining influence with long-standing incumbents. While there is no confirmation of Russian mercenaries (such as Wagner Group) operating in Cameroon as they do in some neighboring states, the information influence is clear – for example, around the time of Biya's military reshuffle, Russian media touted the move as necessary to prevent a Ukraine-style uprising. China, another key foreign partner, tends to be publicly neutral on Cameroon's internal politics, but behind closed doors Beijing has consistently offered diplomatic backing to Biya in forums like the UN, and Chinese state

enterprises – through their local media or corporate social responsibility events – quietly emphasize continuity and investment stability (implicitly favoring the status quo).

Regional powers also play a role. Cameroon's Central African neighbors (Chad, Gabon, Equatorial Guinea, Republic of Congo) are mostly led by entrenched leaders or ruling families themselves, and prefer Biya's continued rule over any uncertain change. There have been no regional pressure or mediation attempts to encourage a truly competitive election; on the contrary, some suspect that regional intelligence-sharing might help Yaoundé's regime keep tabs on exiled dissidents. For instance, Cameroon's security forces reportedly coordinate with neighboring countries to surveil Cameroonian opposition members abroad, which is a form of covert cross-border action. France, the former colonial power, is a more complicated case: historically France propped up Biya, but in recent years Paris has toned down open support amid rising anti-French sentiments in Francophone Africa. French officials now avoid directly endorsing any candidate. However, France's intelligence ties with Cameroon remain strong, and it is widely assumed that French advisors quietly counsel the Cameroonian government on security matters. In August 2025, French President Emmanuel Macron even penned a letter acknowledging France's oppressive role in Cameroon's pre-independence history – a symbolic gesture likely aimed at cooling anti-French sentiment. Still, Paris has not exerted significant pressure for democratic reforms ahead of the election, prioritizing cooperation on counter-terrorism and regional stability. The United States and European Union

publicly call for fair elections, but their leverage is limited by security interests (the U.S., for example, provides counterterrorism training and some military aid, though it did cut certain aid due to human rights abuses) . Western diplomats are thus walking a fine line, issuing pro-democracy statements while trying not to alienate a long-standing partner in a volatile region.

In this milieu, information warfare is raging on all sides. The Cameroonian diaspora and opposition activists abroad use social media to expose regime abuses and rally support, while government-controlled media at home largely ignore or smear the opposition. Fake news and conspiracy theories have flourished, some alleging (without evidence) foreign plots to overthrow Biya, others claiming the regime has secretly printed millions of extra ballots – each side fears the other will resort to unorthodox means. What is clear is that truth is a casualty of this covert struggle. With state media under Biya's thumb and independent journalists under threat, Cameroonians are left deciphering propaganda from all directions, making it even harder for voters to make informed choices. The election is not only a physical contest for votes but an information battlefield, where the regime's covert tactics (domestic manipulation and foreign disinformation) significantly skew the playing field in Biya's favor.

Security Challenges: Conflict and Stability Concerns

Overlaying the political drama is Cameroon's ongoing security crises, which heavily impact the electoral dynamics. The country faces two significant conflicts: the Anglophone separatist crisis in the Northwest and Southwest regions, and the Boko Haram insurgency in the Far North. Both pose challenges for conducting a nationwide election and have been instrumentalized by the regime to justify heavy security measures.

The Anglophone crisis, now in its sixth year, has seen armed separatist groups fighting to create an independent state called "Ambazonia" in the English-speaking regions. This conflict has been devastating: over 6,000 people killed and nearly 700,000 displaced internally, plus about 70-100k refugees in Nigeria . Large swathes of the Northwest and Southwest are in turmoil. Separatist militants vehemently reject the legitimacy of the upcoming election – they view it as a foreign (Francophone) imposition – and have violently enforced election boycotts in past votes . In the 2018 presidential election, turnout in Anglophone areas was barely 5-10% in many localities due to fear and rebel-imposed curfews . A repeat is expected in 2025: separatists have already issued warnings for people to stay home on polling day, and any polling stations that open may be attacked. This means a significant portion of the electorate (20% of the population in those regions) will effectively be disenfranchised or vote under duress. Politically, low turnout there historically disadvantages opposition candidates – the Anglophone populations largely

oppose Biya – but when hardly anyone can vote, it also means the regime can claim victory without needing votes from those areas, while the opposition loses out on potential support. The conflict thus indirectly benefits the incumbent by suppressing votes in opposition strongholds. Moreover, the instability gives the government a convenient rationale to maintain a heavy military presence and restrict campaigning in those regions. Biya's administration insists that security forces must be on high alert in NW/SW, which has unfortunately also translated to harassing even peaceful Anglophone activists and clamping down on opposition activities there under the guise of anti-separatist operations.

In the Far North, Cameroon faces a different challenge from the jihadist militants of Boko Haram (and its splinter ISWAP) spilling over from Nigeria. While Boko Haram's attacks have decreased from their peak several years ago, the group remains active with periodic raids and suicide bombings in border communities. As of 2025, the Far North region remains under a partial security emergency. For the election, Boko Haram's presence raises concerns about voter safety and turnout in affected areas, as well as logistical hurdles in distributing election materials to remote localities. Any major Boko Haram incident during the voting could disrupt the process or delay results from that area. However, interestingly, a relative lull in Boko Haram attacks in early 2025 actually allowed more normal political activity in the Far North, which could favor the opposition if they are able to campaign there. The regime, though, tends to highlight any security threat to justify its authoritarian measures. For instance, government rhetoric frequently

ties the need for Biya's experienced leadership to keeping Cameroon safe from terrorism and chaos – an argument aimed at voters who fear that change could bring insecurity. The Minister of Territorial Administration warned governors in a recent meeting that order must reign “before, during and after” the polls, and even used a metaphor that their “Moulinex is ready to crush anyone who attempts to disrupt the elections” . Such language, invoking a meat-grinder kitchen appliance to threaten troublemakers, underscores how the regime conflates political opposition with security threats.

The interplay of security and politics is thus complex. On one hand, a flawed or violently repressed election could itself trigger unrest, especially among Cameroon's youth who are increasingly frustrated by corruption and lack of opportunity . If the vote is widely seen as a sham, protests could erupt in cities like Yaoundé and Douala – and given the regime's zero-tolerance approach, that risks clashes. Ethno-regional tensions could also flare. Cameroon's population is diverse, and there is historical resentment in some communities (e.g. the Bamileke or other groups) against what they perceive as power monopolization by Biya's Bulu/Beti elite from the Centre-South. A controversial outcome could inflame those sentiments if people feel their regions are once again marginalized by a centrally orchestrated result. On the other hand, a credible and peaceful election (even if Biya were somehow to win fairly) would give the next government a stronger mandate to address these crises – whether through genuine dialogue with Anglophone separatists or refocusing the military on anti-terror operations in the Far North . Unfortunately, given current trends

– Kamto’s exclusion, repression, and the prospect of significant disenfranchisement – the election appears more likely to exacerbate conflicts than resolve them. Already, separatists have stepped up attacks on local officials in Anglophone areas as election preparations begin, and the opposition has fewer avenues to channel popular discontent peacefully. The stability of Cameroon post-election may therefore hang in the balance: if the process lacks legitimacy, it could serve as a flashpoint for wider unrest or even a violent crackdown that pushes the country’s simmering crises into a boil. Both domestic stakeholders and international partners are keenly aware that Cameroon’s stability is at stake in this electoral test.

International Reactions and Outlook

The international community is watching Cameroon’s 2025 election with a mix of concern and cautious engagement. Diplomatic observers note that this vote is part of a broader trend in Africa, testing whether aging strongmen can transition peacefully or whether democratic norms will backslide . So far, reactions to the pre-election developments have been guarded. Western governments and multilateral organizations have issued formal statements emphasizing the need for an inclusive, transparent process. For example, the United States Embassy in Yaoundé expressed disappointment over the exclusion of major candidates (implicitly referring to Kamto) and urged Cameroon to uphold its international human rights commitments during the electoral period. The European Union similarly

called for equal conditions for all contenders and free expression for the public. However, these statements have been measured, and there is little sign yet of punitive actions tied to the election. As recommended by analysts, partners like the U.S. could consider linking future aid or security cooperation to Cameroon's conduct during the election, perhaps even threatening visa bans or aid suspension if egregious violations occur . But any such pressure will likely be applied behind closed doors, given the strategic importance of Cameroon in regional security (counterterrorism and as a stabilizing force in Central Africa).

African regional bodies have been largely quiet. The Central African bloc (ECCAS) rarely intervenes in members' internal politics unless instability spills over borders. The African Union has a team preparing to observe the election, and AU officials have privately emphasized the importance of allowing observers full access. If the AU observer mission reports serious irregularities, it could provide cover for broader international criticism. But absent mass violence, African leaders are generally inclined to accept the outcome as sovereign. Notably, several African heads of state attended Biya's pre-election events or sent envoys to wish him success, indicating tacit support. Neighboring Gabon's president Ali Bongo (before his own ouster in 2023) and Congo's Denis Sassou Nguesso have both been allies who favor continuity in Yaoundé.

France's position is pivotal: Macron's recent acknowledgment of France's past "repressive violence" in Cameroon's colonial era was significant in tone, but Paris has so far avoided directly commenting on Cameroon's candidate vetting or campaign environment. French diplomats have had to tread carefully; open criticism of Biya could backfire given the current anti-French sentiment in parts of Africa, and Biya has adroitly balanced France's influence with new partners like China and Russia. It's worth noting that France did quietly host some Cameroonian opposition figures in exile for dialogues last year – possibly to gauge alternatives – but officially, France maintains it does not meddle in who leads Cameroon. In fact, after a spate of coups against pro-French leaders in West/Central Africa recently, France likely prefers Biya's regime (as problematic as it is) over an unpredictable power vacuum or anti-French successor.

Looking ahead, the post-election trajectory will depend on how credible and peaceful the process is. In a best-case scenario, if by some miracle the election were competitive and the outcome accepted by all, Cameroon could embark on reforms to tackle corruption, dialogue with Anglophone separatists, and reinvigorate its economy – steps that would be welcomed and supported by international partners. However, given the current course, the likely scenario is a contested result that many Cameroonians and observers deem illegitimate. Should Biya be declared winner amid low turnout and allegations of fraud or exclusion, the immediate international response may be muted (no one expects street protests in Cameroon to unseat him as happened in Sudan or Algeria). But over time,

Cameroon risks further isolation. Already, the U.S. has scaled back some military aid due to the army's human rights abuses in the Anglophone regions . A blatantly rigged election could trigger more targeted sanctions – for instance, visa bans on officials or even pressure within the IMF/World Bank if governance deteriorates. The EU Parliament could revive resolutions condemning Cameroon (as it did after Kamto's 2019 arrest). Even regional allies might distance themselves diplomatically if Cameroon's stability falters – say, if violent crackdowns lead to a refugee outflow.

In sum, Cameroon's 2025 election is a watershed moment with ramifications far beyond its borders. Domestically, it is exposing the lengths to which Africa's oldest leader and his network will go to retain power, from reshuffling generals to jailing opponents and tweaking laws . The dynamics of elite conflict, repression, and manipulation we have detailed suggest the election will be neither free nor fair by standard definitions. International actors are already preparing for the aftermath: whether that means crisis diplomacy to prevent violence or a pragmatic acceptance of the status quo. For the Cameroonian people – over 60% of whom are under 30 and have never known a president other than Biya – the election offers a glimmer of change on paper but, as of now, little genuine hope for a democratic breakthrough. Without Kamto on the ballot and without basic freedoms, the exercise risks being a hollow ritual that prolongs a painful impasse. The world will be watching October 12, but even more crucial will be October 13 and beyond: how the regime handles any dissent, how the opposition recalibrates its strategy,

and whether Cameroon can navigate its succession dilemma without descending into the kind of instability that has roiled other countries in the region. The coming weeks will thus be critical in determining if Cameroon's future holds reform and reconciliation – or further entrenchment of an aging autocracy under mounting pressure.

Sources: Recent Reuters and Xinhua news dispatches; Human Rights Watch and Amnesty International reports; Atlantic Council analysis; local Cameroon news outlets (Eco Outlook, Cameroon Online) for on-the-ground developments; and social media/OSINT monitoring .